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Intel Corp (INTC.O)

Potential Partnership with SK Hynix

CITI'S TAKE

[Reuters](#) (16-Sept-2026) reported that SK Hynix is in exploratory talks with Intel to manufacture memory chips in the US for the first time, with potential structures including leasing capacity at Intel's Ohio fab or a JV involving Intel and large cloud service providers. Though SK Hynix clarified that no specific plans or arrangements have been finalized at this time, we believe the news is consistent with comments from Intel CEO Lip-Bu Tan at the AI Infra Summit yesterday, where he emphasized that Intel cannot build every capability internally and intends to partner where others have stronger technology positions, while focusing on areas where it can lead, such as advanced packaging, including EMIB-T. We believe the discussions could represent another step toward expanding Intel's partnership with SpaceX, with SK Hynix/Intel potentially providing the US-based memory manufacturing capability that complements Intel's 14A and advanced packaging offerings.

Buy

Price (15 Sep 26 16:00)	US\$97.14
Target price	US\$130.00
Expected share price return	33.8%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	33.8%
Market Cap	US\$513,392M

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Figure 1. SK Hynix Potential Partnership with Intel



Eyes U.S. Memory Production, Deepening Intel Ties

Aspect	Key Points	Details
Potential U.S. Memory Production	Could Lease Part of Intel's Ohio Fab	Would mark the company's first-ever U.S.-based memory production , if realized
	Could Form a Venture with Intel/ Major CSPs	
Current U.S. Footprint	Indiana Advanced Packaging Plant	Poised to become its first U.S. HBM advanced packaging base Mass production: 2H29
Key Hurdles	Potential Seoul Pushback Over Advanced Tech Transfer Abroad	Could ease Trump admin pressure for U.S. manufacturing
Current Intel Ties	Potential EMIB Collaboration	Reportedly conducting R&D on EMIB-based 2.5D packaging with its HBM
	Ex-SK hynix CEO Seok-Hee Lee Named Intel Foundry EVP	Intel rules out memory production; Lee's appointment signals confidence in EMIB-T growth

Source: Reuters, ZDNet, [Investing.com](https://www.investing.com) and SK hynix



Source: TrendForce

Intel Corp

Valuation

We value INTC based on our SOTP valuation, our price target is \$130. We apply a SOTP valuation framework to each of Intel's reportable segments and to highlight our growth expectations for Intel Foundry.

Risks

PC end-market: Intel derives roughly 90% of sales from the PC and server segments, which are highly dependent on IT spending. Therefore, any major uptick/downtick in IT spending could result in upside/downside to our estimates and cause us to reassess our rating on INTC.

M&A: If Intel engages in a substantial accretive acquisition, it could result in upside to our estimates.

Competition: Intel competes directly with AMD in the microprocessor market. Consequently, any fluctuations in market share between Intel and AMD could result in risk to our estimates.

Customer risk: Intel's largest PC OEM customers collectively represent roughly 45% Intel's revenue. As a result, any major declines in orders from PC OEMs could have a negative effect on our estimates for Intel.

Macroeconomic: Intel's geographic exposure spans multiple geographies including the U.S., Europe, and Asia. As a result, any prolonged macroeconomic downturn/upturn could result in downside/upside to our estimates and rating.

If the impact from the above risks turns out to be greater/less than we anticipate, the shares could fail to achieve or could exceed our target price.

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Appendix A-1

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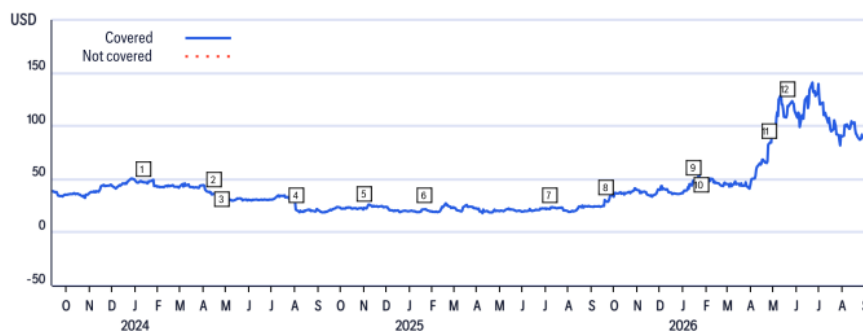
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Intel Corp (INTC)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	12-Jan-24 06:06:09	2	*47.50	47.12
2	15-Apr-24 06:04:21	2	*40.00	36.31
3	26-Apr-24 03:00:00	2	*35.00	31.88
4	02-Aug-24 08:05:49	2	*25.00	21.48

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	01-Nov-24 03:17:08	2	*22.00	23.20
6	21-Jan-25 03:00:00	2	*21.00	21.77
7	07-Jul-25 03:00:00	2	*24.00	22.00
8	19-Sep-25 02:10:39	*3	*29.00	29.58

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9	15-Jan-26 07:24:43	*2	*50.00	48.32
10	23-Jan-26 01:48:19	2	*48.00	45.07
11	24-Apr-26 06:29:21	*1	*95.00	82.54
12	18-May-26 05:00:00	1	*130.00	108.17

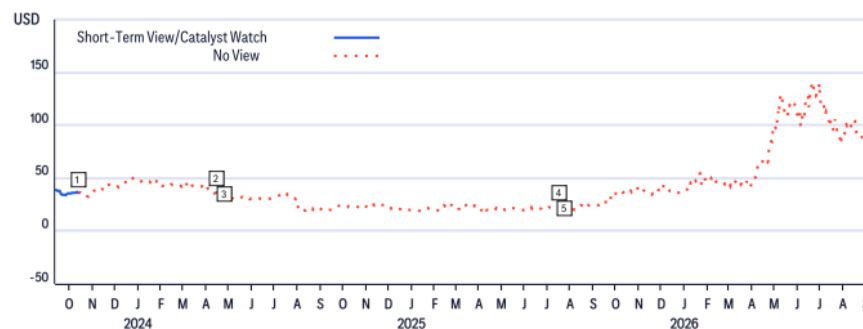
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Intel Corp (INTC)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	15-Oct-23 12:07:05	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	35.97
2	15-Apr-24 02:04:21	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	36.31

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	25-Apr-24 23:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	35.11
4	17-Jul-25 23:00:00	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	22.80

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	24-Jul-25 23:00:00	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	22.63

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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